NCE EXAM PREP

Practice Exam 17

Domain 5

Indirect Client Care

21 Practice Questions | 28 minutes

A, B, C answer choices

Answer Key and Explanations included

> **Instructions.** Select the single best answer for each question. Record your answers separately. This domain practice set is drawn from Full-Length Practice Exam 03. Use the suggested 28-minute practice timer. Do not consult Part B until you complete Part A. These domain timings are editorial practice allocations, not official NBCC section limits.

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PART A — QUESTIONS

Choose one answer (A, B, or C) per question.

Question 1

Which action best demonstrates a closed-loop referral?

A) Give the client a current list of several agencies and wait for the client to mention the referral again

B) Select one agency for the client and assume that sending its contact information completes the referral

C) Confirm whether the client connected with the selected service and, with the client's involvement, address barriers or identify an alternative

Question 2

> An elementary-school client uses a picture-based emotion scale in counseling. With the child and parent's authorization, the counselor is coordinating with a speech-language pathologist, who uses a different set of symbols during communication sessions. The child becomes frustrated when the symbols do not match.

What is the best collaborative action?

A) Ask the pathologist to stop using communication supports outside counseling

B) Compare the systems and agree on consistent, developmentally appropriate symbols that support the child's goals across settings

C) Send all counseling notes so the pathologist can select the child's treatment approach

Question 3

> Mina receives individual counseling from a community therapist and brief counseling through her college. She has authorized the two counselors to coordinate because both have begun addressing test anxiety, and the different homework assignments feel contradictory to her.

What should the counselors do?

A) Continue separate plans so each counselor can independently determine which approach works better

B) Include Mina in clarifying each provider's role, align the goals, and agree on how relevant updates will be exchanged

C) Have the college counselor end services automatically because community counseling is more comprehensive

Question 4

> During a telehealth session, repeated video freezing prevents the counselor from observing facial expression for much of the meeting. Audio remains clear, and the client participates throughout. The counselor is completing the mental-status portion of the note.

What is the best documentation approach?

A) Record facial expression as normal because the client sounded engaged

B) Document the audiovisual limitation, record what was observable or reported, and avoid conclusions that required a clear image

C) Omit the entire mental-status section because one observational channel was limited

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Question 5

> During a telehealth session, the audio connection to the qualified Arabic interpreter repeatedly fails. The client says that continuing in English would be difficult and prefers to stop until effective interpretation is available. The clinic can access a backup interpreter service.

What should the counselor do?

A) Continue in simplified English because the session has already begun

B) Use the backup qualified interpreter service or reschedule according to the client's preference

C) Ask the client to type sensitive answers into a public translation website

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Question 6

Which documentation of a clinical consultation is most useful for continuity of care?

A) "Consulted with supervisor" without identifying the issue or resulting plan

B) A verbatim transcript of the entire consultation, including unrelated cases discussed afterward

C) The consultation question, relevant case facts, recommendations received, and the counselor's resulting decision and follow-up

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Question 7

> Elena wants to enroll in a parenting-support program that requires an online intake. She has no email address, limited digital experience, and access only to a basic mobile telephone. The program also offers staff-assisted intake by telephone, but this option is not shown on its website.

What is the counselor's best referral support?

A) Tell Elena to create an email account and complete the online process independently

B) Verify the staff-assisted option and help Elena connect with it while allowing her to provide her own information

C) Complete the online form in Elena's name using an agency email account

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Question 8

> Caleb tells his counselor that his pharmacy is out of a prescribed medication and that he has two doses remaining. He reports no current symptoms and asks whether he should skip doses to make the supply last. The counselor has authorization to contact the prescriber and pharmacy.

What is the counselor's most appropriate response?

A) Tell Caleb to take half-doses so the remaining supply lasts longer

B) Document the access problem and help Caleb promptly contact the prescriber and pharmacy for verified continuity instructions

C) Recommend borrowing the same medication from a family member until the pharmacy restocks it

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Question 9

> Imani is moving from a domestic-violence shelter to permanent housing and has authorized coordination among the counselor, a housing advocate, and a nonprofit that has temporarily fostered her cat. Imani says reuniting with the cat is important to feeling settled, but the housing plan does not yet address the building's pet requirements.

What should the counselor facilitate?

A) Add Imani's pet-reunification goal to the coordination plan and clarify the advocate's and nonprofit's related next steps

B) Exclude the cat from planning because animal care is unrelated to emotional well-being

C) Ask the nonprofit to return the cat immediately before the housing requirements are confirmed

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Question 10

> Rania requests counseling in Levantine Arabic. At intake, she says that the assigned interpreter's dialect is difficult for her to understand and that she is missing parts of the conversation. The interpreter is qualified but does not speak her preferred dialect.

What should the counselor do?

A) Continue because interpreter credentials matter more than dialect differences

B) Ask Rania to guess at unfamiliar words and correct misunderstandings after the intake

C) Pause the intake and arrange a qualified interpreter who can communicate effectively in Rania's preferred dialect

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Question 11

> Keisha authorizes a neuropsychologist to send her counselor a recent evaluation before their next session. The report is 30 pages long and includes broad testing results. Keisha's counseling goal is to improve organization at work, and she has not asked the counselor to interpret the full test battery.

How should the counselor use the report in preparing for the session?

A) Replace the existing counseling plan with every recommendation in the evaluation

B) Set the report aside because a counselor did not administer the tests

C) Review findings and recommendations relevant to Keisha's goal and note questions that require clarification

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Question 12

> Jamal receives a long-acting medication at a specialty clinic. He missed the latest appointment because the clinic moved, and the old telephone number now plays a disconnected message. Jamal reports no acute symptoms, and his authorization permits coordination with the clinic and prescriber.

What should the counselor do?

A) Verify the clinic's current access information and help Jamal reconnect promptly with the medication team

B) Tell Jamal that missing one appointment is unlikely to matter and wait for the clinic to contact him

C) Recommend an oral substitute until Jamal locates the new clinic

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Question 13

> Before a session, a counselor reviews a symptom measure the client completed at home. One required item is blank, and the scoring instructions do not permit the counselor to treat a missing response as zero. The incomplete measure has not yet been discussed with the client.

How should the counselor prepare to use the measure?

A) Score the blank item as zero because that produces the most conservative total

B) Discard the measure and avoid mentioning it because it cannot be scored immediately

C) Flag the missing item, plan to clarify it with the client, and interpret the measure only as allowed after clarification

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Question 14

> Because writing is physically painful, Rowan and the counselor agreed that Rowan could complete a between-session reflection as a voice memo rather than in a journal. Rowan brings the recording to the next session and discusses two themes that emerged.

Which progress-note entry is most appropriate?

A) Record that Rowan completed the reflection in the agreed audio format, summarize the relevant themes and response, and state the next plan

B) Document that the written homework was not completed and omit the voice memo because it used a different format

C) Describe the full contents of the recording even when portions were unrelated to the counseling goal

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Question 15

> A counselor's draft note states, "The client used paced breathing and reported lower tension" under the heading Intervention. It does not identify what the counselor did during the exercise. The note has not yet been signed.

How should the counselor revise the entry?

A) Keep the statement as written because the client's action is sufficient to identify the intervention

B) Record the counselor's breathing instruction under the intervention and the client's practice and reported change under the response

C) Move the entire statement to the plan section because breathing should occur between sessions

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Question 16

Which case-conference agenda is most likely to produce effective stakeholder coordination?

A) A complete retelling of the client's history followed by open discussion with no assigned follow-up

B) Separate presentations ranked by each participant's professional seniority

C) Client-defined goals, decisions needed, participant responsibilities, and a method and date for follow-up

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Question 17

A client converses comfortably in English but requests a qualified interpreter for complex counseling discussions. What is the best response?

A) Decline because conversational English shows that interpretation is unnecessary

B) Ask a bilingual relative to remain available only if the client becomes confused

C) Arrange qualified interpretation in the client's preferred language rather than assuming conversational fluency is sufficient

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Question 18

> While reviewing an unsigned note, a counselor realizes that a sentence placed inside quotation marks is a paraphrase of the client's statement rather than the client's exact words. The paraphrase is otherwise accurate.

What should the counselor do before signing the note?

A) Remove the quotation marks and identify the content as the client's reported meaning

B) Keep the quotation marks because the paraphrase accurately captures the client's intent

C) Delete the statement because only exact quotations may appear in a progress note

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Question 19

> A 16-year-old client wants to continue both a counseling skills group and the school basketball team, but their schedules overlap twice each month. The client and guardian authorize the counselor to coordinate scheduling with the school counselor and coach. The client does not want clinical details shared with the coach.

What coordination approach best supports the client?

A) Compare schedule alternatives with the client and authorized stakeholders while limiting communication to the participation issue

B) Ask the client to leave the team because counseling should take precedence over extracurricular activities

C) Explain the client's symptoms to the coach so the coach understands why schedule flexibility is necessary

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Question 20

> Andre receives hemodialysis three mornings per week and is often fatigued afterward. He has authorized coordination between his counselor and the dialysis social worker. Several afternoon counseling appointments have been canceled on treatment days, but Andre wants to continue counseling.

Which coordination response is most appropriate?

A) With Andre's input, align counseling times with the dialysis schedule and establish a continuity plan for treatment-related disruptions

B) Close Andre's counseling case because medical treatment makes regular attendance uncertain

C) Ask the dialysis social worker to decide when Andre is emotionally ready for counseling

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Question 21

> Tariq has authorized a volunteer recovery mentor to participate in support planning. The mentor begins sending the counselor long daily messages about Tariq's routine, although Tariq originally requested only a weekly update about attendance at community activities.

How should the counselor manage the collaboration?

A) Reconfirm Tariq's desired involvement and establish a structured update schedule and relevant content with the mentor

B) Accept all daily messages because more collateral information always improves counseling decisions

C) End the mentor's involvement without consulting Tariq because the messages are too frequent

PART B — ANSWER KEY AND EXPLANATIONS

Answers match the numbered items in Part A.

Question 1 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Confirm whether the client connected with the selected service and, with the client's involvement, address barriers or identify an alternative

Explanation: A closed-loop referral includes checking whether the intended connection actually occurred and responding when it did not. This approach keeps the client involved while preventing a referral from ending with contact information alone. Assuming that information transfer equals service access leaves barriers undiscovered.

Question 2 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Compare the systems and agree on consistent, developmentally appropriate symbols that support the child's goals across settings

Explanation: Coordinating the visual vocabulary can reduce frustration and reinforce the child's communication across services. The counselor and pathologist each contribute relevant expertise while keeping the child's goals central. Full counseling notes are not needed to compare and align the symbols.

Question 3 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Include Mina in clarifying each provider's role, align the goals, and agree on how relevant updates will be exchanged

Explanation: Role clarification can reduce contradictory assignments while allowing each provider to contribute within an agreed scope. Mina's participation keeps the plan tied to her needs and preferences. Automatically ending one service is unnecessary when coordinated, complementary roles may be possible.

Question 4 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Document the audiovisual limitation, record what was observable or reported, and avoid conclusions that required a clear image

Explanation: The note should represent both the available audio information and the limits of visual observation. Clear documentation of the technology limitation prevents later readers from treating unobserved features as assessed. One restricted channel does not require omitting all other mental-status information.

Question 5 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Use the backup qualified interpreter service or reschedule according to the client's preference

Explanation: Effective language access is necessary for the client to participate meaningfully in the session. A backup qualified service or client-preferred rescheduling addresses the failed connection without pressuring the client to proceed in a less effective language. Public translation tools are not an adequate substitute for live interpretation of sensitive counseling content.

Question 6 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: The consultation question, relevant case facts, recommendations received, and the counselor's resulting decision and follow-up

Explanation: These elements show why consultation occurred, what guidance was obtained, and how the counselor used it. A vague statement does not support later understanding of the decision. A full transcript would add unnecessary material without improving continuity.

Question 7 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Verify the staff-assisted option and help Elena connect with it while allowing her to provide her own information

Explanation: The telephone option removes the digital barrier while preserving Elena's control over the information she supplies. Verifying the pathway before referral reduces another failed access attempt. Completing an application in her name would unnecessarily replace her participation.

Question 8 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Document the access problem and help Caleb promptly contact the prescriber and pharmacy for verified continuity instructions

Explanation: The supply interruption requires timely guidance from the professionals responsible for prescribing and dispensing the medication. The counselor can document the barrier and facilitate that contact without changing how Caleb takes the medication. Advising skipped, reduced, or borrowed doses would exceed the counselor's role and could be unsafe.

Question 9 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Add Imani's pet-reunification goal to the coordination plan and clarify the advocate's and nonprofit's related next steps

Explanation: Imani identified reunification as meaningful to settling safely into permanent housing. Including pet requirements and role-specific tasks in the plan addresses a concrete transition need before the foster arrangement ends. Immediate return would be premature until the building requirements are confirmed.

Question 10 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Pause the intake and arrange a qualified interpreter who can communicate effectively in Rania's preferred dialect

Explanation: Credentials alone do not create effective communication when the client cannot understand the interpreter's dialect. Pausing and matching language support to Rania's stated need protects the accuracy of the intake. Expecting her to guess would shift responsibility for the communication failure to the client.

Question 11 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Review findings and recommendations relevant to Keisha's goal and note questions that require clarification

Explanation: Focused review helps the counselor prepare around Keisha's stated goal without treating a broad specialist report as an automatic counseling plan. Questions about technical findings can be identified for later clarification with Keisha or the evaluator. Ignoring the report would discard potentially useful functional information.

Question 12 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Verify the clinic's current access information and help Jamal reconnect promptly with the medication team

Explanation: The missed appointment resulted from an outdated access pathway, so current information and prompt reconnection are the relevant supports. The medication team can determine any clinical response to the delay. Recommending a substitute would place the counselor in a prescribing role.

Question 13 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Flag the missing item, plan to clarify it with the client, and interpret the measure only as allowed after clarification

Explanation: The scoring instructions explicitly rule out substituting zero for the missing response. Preparing to clarify the item preserves the measure's intended use and avoids creating a misleading score. The incomplete form may still become usable after the client addresses the omission.

Question 14 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Record that Rowan completed the reflection in the agreed audio format, summarize the relevant themes and response, and state the next plan

Explanation: The audio reflection fulfilled the adapted assignment and produced material relevant to the counseling goal. The note should document the completed task, clinical response, and next step rather than labeling a format difference as noncompletion. Unrelated recording content need not be copied into the record.

Question 15 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Record the counselor's breathing instruction under the intervention and the client's practice and reported change under the response

Explanation: Separating the counselor's action from the client's response makes the note clinically interpretable. The original sentence describes only what the client did and experienced, leaving the intervention unclear. The plan section should identify future action rather than replace documentation of what occurred.

Question 16 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Client-defined goals, decisions needed, participant responsibilities, and a method and date for follow-up

Explanation: This agenda links the meeting to the client's aims and converts discussion into accountable next steps. Decisions, responsibilities, and follow-up make coordination observable after the meeting. Professional seniority is not a substitute for a task-focused plan.

Question 17 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Arrange qualified interpretation in the client's preferred language rather than assuming conversational fluency is sufficient

Explanation: Everyday conversation does not establish that a client can fully understand or express complex counseling content in English. The client's request is direct information about what support is needed for meaningful participation. A relative is not an equivalent substitute for qualified interpretation.

Question 18 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Remove the quotation marks and identify the content as the client's reported meaning

Explanation: Quotation marks indicate exact language, which the counselor knows was not recorded. Identifying the sentence as a paraphrased client report preserves its accurate meaning without overstating precision. Useful reported content does not need to be deleted merely because it is not a direct quotation.

Question 19 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Compare schedule alternatives with the client and authorized stakeholders while limiting communication to the participation issue

Explanation: The authorization supports focused logistical coordination that can preserve two activities the client values. Clinical details are not needed to compare schedules and identify workable accommodations. Requiring the client to abandon the team would bypass collaborative problem-solving.

Question 20 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: With Andre's input, align counseling times with the dialysis schedule and establish a continuity plan for treatment-related disruptions

Explanation: The attendance pattern has a predictable treatment-related context that can be addressed through coordinated scheduling. A continuity plan respects Andre's wish to remain in counseling while preparing for disruptions. The dialysis social worker can collaborate but should not decide Andre's emotional readiness.

Question 21 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Reconfirm Tariq's desired involvement and establish a structured update schedule and relevant content with the mentor

Explanation: Tariq should continue to define how the mentor participates in his support plan. A clear schedule and content boundary can preserve useful collaboration without allowing excessive collateral material to drive counseling. Ending the relationship unilaterally would also disregard Tariq's choice.
